

## Sales Training — Session 27

# Booking the Second-Opinion Call.

## Read the Traffic. Use Real Numbers. Show Don't Tell.

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**WHAT THIS SESSION IS** How to convert a discovery call into a booked meeting when the buyer already has a provider — using the SEM Rush data on the screen, the traffic profile in front of you, and a tone that doesn't trash the competition.

### 1. The frame: "Second opinion" beats "switch providers"

The buyer who says "I already have a provider" isn't saying no. They're saying don't insult what I've already paid for. If the rep responds with "yeah they're not great" — even when it's true — the buyer's defences fire. The provider is now a sunk cost the buyer has to defend. The rep has put them on the wrong side of the conversation.

The second-opinion frame avoids that trap. The rep is not asking the buyer to switch — they're offering an unbiased professional read. The buyer can take or leave it. That framing is the doorway through which most of these meetings actually get booked.

*"This is the areas where it's going really well. There's areas I can see for improvement. I'm not trying to step on anyone's toes. I do think you'll value getting a second unbiased opinion. Whether you change or not — completely up to you."*

Notice what that does. It acknowledges what's working (so the buyer doesn't have to defend it). It signals competence (the rep has already read the data). And it lowers the stakes (no commitment beyond looking). The buyer is no longer being sold to — they're being offered something for free.

### 2. Specific numbers beat round numbers

When a rep says "your traffic is down about 20%," the buyer hears a guess. When a rep says "your traffic is down 23.5% this month," the buyer hears someone who has actually looked at the data. The same fact lands very differently.

This is the SEM Rush move. The rep pulls the campaign up on screen before the call, finds the percentage already showing next to the traffic, and uses it verbatim. Not rounded. Not approximated. The exact number — because the exact number is the credibility.

*"Don't be too alarmed, but your traffic has gone down by 23.5% this month — which is probably to do with your ranking slipping. I understand you're doing something. Can I have 15 minutes of your time next week to show this on the software?"*

Three moves in one line: real number, calm tone, modest ask. "Don't be too alarmed" defuses panic. The diagnosis ("ranking slipping") is a hypothesis the rep will prove in the meeting, not on the call. The ask is bounded (15 minutes) and easy to grant.

### 3. The traffic matrix — read the volume, choose the angle

Every site falls into a traffic profile. The rep's job is to read which one is in front of them and pick the matching conversation. Trying to use a low-traffic pitch on a high-traffic site makes the rep sound out of their depth. Below is the working matrix from the session:

| Traffic profile                           | What it tells you                                                                 | Booking angle                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Low traffic (under ~300/mo)               | Site is largely invisible. The current campaign — if any — isn't producing.       | Easy book. "Your site is barely getting seen — I'd like 15 minutes to show you what's missing."                                   |
| Mid traffic with recent decrease          | Provider may have eased off, rankings have slipped, or algorithm change hit them. | Use the specific number. "Traffic is down 23.5% this month — that's a ranking slip. Worth 15 minutes?"                            |
| Healthy traffic (1,000+/mo) but poor site | SEO is working. The site lets the traffic through. Conversion is the leak.        | Pivot to web. "SEO is doing its job — the site isn't catching what it sends. A couple of tweaks could change that."               |
| High traffic, strong campaign             | Already in good hands. Don't try to displace — position as a second opinion.      | "You're doing better than most. I'd still love to give you a 10-minute professional second opinion — even if you change nothing." |

Build this into a one-page reference for the desk. Over a week, tick each profile as it comes up — the team will quickly learn which conversation they're underprepared for, and which they handle well already.

### 4. The keyword test — narrow the search, sharpen the pitch

Most buyers can't talk about "SEO" in the abstract. They can talk about jobs they actually do. The rep's job is to extract a specific service area and a specific suburb, type it into SEM Rush during the call, and read the position back on the spot. "Do you prefer to work in Unley or Parkside?" is a sales question dressed up as a curiosity question — the answer narrows the keyword, and the rank check that follows gives the rep the bookable hook.

*"You're sitting on page two for that keyword. It's not far off — a bit of targeted work usually moves something like this onto page one inside a couple of months. That's worth 15 minutes to walk through."*

Position 11+ is page two. Anything past page two is essentially invisible. Both findings are bookable — page two is a near-miss the buyer can taste, page three+ is a problem they didn't know they had. The rep narrates the finding, then asks for the meeting.

### 5. The pricing jab — a calculated underestimate

A more advanced move, used sparingly. When the buyer says they're already doing marketing, the rep deliberately under-quotes what they think the buyer is spending. "It looks

like you're spending around \$300 a month — I'd recommend stepping that up." If the buyer is actually paying \$1,000, the underestimate stings — and the sting is the booking. The buyer wants to correct the record, which means they want to keep talking.

This is not about insulting the buyer or the current provider. It's a controlled provocation that gets a second meeting onto the calendar. Used carelessly it sounds rude. Used carefully, it produces an instant "actually we're spending more than that" — and the rep replies, "interesting, then we definitely need to look at what you're getting for it." Meeting booked.

**WHEN TO USE THE JAB** Only on buyers who are clearly invested in their marketing already (they've named their provider, they have an opinion about results). Never on a small business owner who's tentative or new to it — they'll just feel embarrassed and the call ends.

## 6. Show, don't tell — the show-and-tell close

The single most reliable booking line in this session was a variation of: "It's much easier if I show you rather than talking on the phone — it gets confusing otherwise." That line is not a deflection. It's an honest framing of a sales reality: SEO and web data look complicated when described out loud, and become obvious when seen on screen.

The buyer is more comfortable being shown something than being talked at. "Show you" implies a screen, which implies a meeting, which is the close. The line works because it's true — and because it makes the rep look reasonable rather than pushy.

*"I've got a lot to show you — about 5 to 10 minutes' worth. It's much easier if I show you rather than talk on the phone, because it can get confusing. When's a quiet half-hour next week?"*

## 7. Soft frame: "whether you go with us or not"

A line worth carrying into every second-opinion conversation: "Whether you go with us or someone else, you need to look at this." That framing puts the rep on the buyer's side of the table, not in competition with them. The implicit message is the rep cares about the buyer's outcome more than the rep's own commission.

In practice, when the rep means it, the buyer feels it — and a fair share of those buyers then book the meeting and stay. The rep who plays this honestly converts at a higher rate than the rep who plays it as a manipulation, because buyers can smell the difference. So the rule of thumb is simple: only say it when it's true. Sometimes the buyer's current provider is fine, and the right thing to say is "keep doing what you're doing." That credibility compounds.

## 8. When the buyer pushes back: open the door, don't crash through

If the buyer says "I'm fine with my current setup" or "I'm not interested in changing," the rep doesn't argue. They probe gently to understand what "fine" actually means. Often "fine" just means "not interested in a cold call right now" — not "my campaign is performing."

The move is to step back, offer an email follow-up with a couple of specific data points (the rep already has the traffic number, the ranking position, and the page-two keyword), and ask if a quick 5–10 minute screen-share next week would be welcome. The email gives the buyer a chance to look at the data on their own time, which often softens them up for the meeting.

*"Totally hear you. Let me send through a quick email with a couple of things I've noticed — no pressure, just so you've got it. Then if anything in there is interesting, we can grab 10 minutes next week. Sound fair?"*

## 9. The tone that gets bookings

Three tonal notes ran through every successful example in the session. First, calm — never alarmed, never urgent. The rep is reading data on a screen, not running a fire drill. Second, technical but accessible — enough specifics (a percentage, a position, a keyword) to sound competent, but not so much jargon that the buyer disengages. Third, generous — acknowledging what's working before pointing at what isn't. Buyers who feel respected book meetings. Buyers who feel cornered hang up.

If a rep finds themselves talking faster, raising their voice, or interrupting — that's commission breath leaking through (see Session 24). Slow the tempo. Lower the volume. The data does the convincing. The rep just narrates.

## 10. Action items for the team

1. Before any prospect call: open SEM Rush on the screen. Have the traffic number, the trend percentage, and at least one ranking position ready before you dial.
2. Build a one-page traffic matrix card (use Section 3 above) and keep it next to the phone. Tick the profile that comes up each day for two weeks.
3. Memorise the second-opinion frame and the show-don't-tell close — these two lines do most of the booking work.
4. When you find a page-two keyword for a buyer's service+suburb, use the exact position number ("position 11" not "page two") — specificity is credibility.
5. Use the pricing jab sparingly and only on confident, invested buyers. Never on a tentative small business owner.
6. If the buyer pushes back, send the email with the data, ask for 10 minutes next week, and don't argue. The email + meeting combo converts better than the call alone.
7. Track every call against the traffic matrix this week. At Friday's debrief, bring the count for each profile so we can see where the team is strongest and weakest.

**THE RULE OF THUMB** If you can't tell the buyer something true and specific about their site in the first ninety seconds, you haven't done enough homework to deserve the meeting. Open SEM Rush before you pick up the phone.